Screening

Consent Form

Welcome and thank you for your interest in our study on puberty and emotions.

This form allows you to provide consent for you and your child to participate in this research.

The next few questions will make sure you and your child are eligible, then you will be given more detailed study information.

Click on the arrows below to move forwards or backwards between sections.

Do you and your child live in Australia?

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Are you the parent or legal guardian of your child?

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Are you 18 years or older?

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Is your child 12–17 years old?

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Is your child's sex* female?

* 'Sex' here means their sex recorded at birth (i.e., the sex on their original birth certificate). If their sex is female, please tick yes even if their gender identity does not align with their sex.

- ○ No
- ○ Yes

Does your child have any of the following:

- A thyroid condition
- Polycystic ovary syndrome
- Diabetes (type 1 or 2)
- Cushing's syndrome
- Addison's disease / adrenal insufficiency
- Turner syndrome
- Klinefelter syndrome
- Congenital adrenal hyperplasia
- Precocious puberty

○ No
○ Yes

PLS

It looks like you and your child are eligible to participate.

Next, you will be given information about the study so you can decide whether you want to participate.

There is written study information (the Plain Language Statement). There are also video and audio versions if you prefer.

You can access the study information in one of these formats. If you choose video or audio format, you will also be able to download a copy of the written information afterwards.

I would prefer

- ○ Written study information
- ○ Video study information
- ○ Audio study information

TO: Caregivers

Plain Language Statement

Date: 30/09/2025
Full Project Title: Influences of puberty on emotions in females with and without ADHD
Student Investigator: Emily Friedel
Principal Investigator: Professor Tim Silk
Associate Investigator: Dr Lisa Grech
Associate Investigator: Dr Nandi Vijayakumar

Invitation

You are invited to take part in a study exploring how puberty influences the emotions of female adolescents, including those with ADHD and without ADHD. ('Female' here means sex recorded at birth is female.)

The research is being conducted by Emily Friedel as part of her Doctor of Philosophy (Psychology) course requirements and is supervised by the Principal Investigator, Professor Tim Silk, and Associate Investigators, Dr Lisa Grech and Dr Nandi Vijayakumar. All researchers are from the School of Psychology at Deakin University.

Before you decide whether to participate, it is important that you understand why the research is being done and what your participation will involve. Please read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish.

What is the purpose of this study?

Puberty is a time of significant change, but we know little about how these changes may

affect emotions differently for female adolescents with ADHD compared to their non-ADHD peers. This study aims to improve understanding of how puberty might relate to emotions and whether this differs for females with and without ADHD.

Why have I been invited to participate in this study?

You have been invited to participate in this study as the caregiver (parent or guardian) of a young person aged 12-17 whose sex recorded at birth is female and who is living in Australia.

What does this study involve?

If you agree to participate in this research, you and your child will each be asked to complete a survey that takes approximately 10-15 minutes. The survey can be completed at a time that suits you and your child from any place with internet access.
Each survey will ask for information about:

- Whether your child has ADHD.
- Your child's pubertal development (that is, how far through puberty they have progressed).
- Whether they have started menstruating (if so, whether they are using hormonal birth control).
- Their emotions and moods. For example, if they have very strong emotions and whether they have felt unhappy lately.

In addition, your survey will ask some questions about your child's:

- Attention, activity levels, and impulse control
- Mental health
- Medications
- Health conditions

Note: If you start the survey and want to come back later, you can bookmark it in your internet browser and then return to the bookmark on the same device within one week.

Are there risks and benefits to me in taking part in this study?

Participation in this study does not provide any immediate benefits to you. However, this research will contribute to understanding how puberty might impact the psychological wellbeing of young people with and without ADHD. This may help inform how we support female adolescents with ADHD.

Although the risks of participation are minimal, due to the personal nature of the information being collected as part of this study, there is a small risk of psychological distress. If you become distressed because of participation in this research, you can stop the survey and withdraw without any negative consequences. If you require further support, you can contact one of the services listed below:

Beyond Blue Mental Health Support 1300 224 636
Lifeline Crisis Support 13 11 14
SANE Support Line 1800 187 263

Alternatively, you can contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator) who can help you find appropriate support services in Australia: e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

What if I don't want to take part in this study?

Participation in this research is voluntary. Only those people who give informed consent for themselves and their child will be included in this study, and your child will also need to agree to participate.

Whether you participate is entirely your decision, and you will not be disadvantaged if you choose not to participate.

Similarly, you can give consent for your child to participate, but they can still decide whether to complete the survey. If they choose not to participate, you can still fill out the survey for caregivers.

What if I participate and want to withdraw later?

Any information you or your child put into the survey will be collected and may be analysed. This means that stopping the survey before completion does not automatically withdraw data.

If you do not want your or your child's survey responses included in this study, you can contact the research team (e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439). If the study results have not yet been analysed, we may be able to remove your data. If so, we can send a form for you to fill out to withdraw consent. Please note that we plan to start the analysis by 15 June 2026.

However, it will not be possible to remove your responses if the results have been analysed. If this is the case, the research team will let you know.

Ensuring this project is ethical

This study has received Deakin University ethics approval (reference number: 2025/HE001102). The study will be conducted in accordance with the ethical standards provided by the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Human Research 2025.

The Deakin University Human Research Ethics Committee will monitor the progress of this project to uphold the rights and safety of all participants. Any deviations from ethical standards or protocol will be quickly identified, addressed, and reported in accordance with the guidelines set out in the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Human Research.

How will my privacy and confidentiality be protected?

Your survey responses will be de-identified so that it will not be possible to identify you from your answers. Identifying information (your name on the consent form and email address) will be collected and stored separately from survey responses to ensure your privacy is protected.

Any information you share is confidential, except where disclosure is required by law (given research data is not privileged data).

Data collected from you will be retained on a secure data repository at Deakin University for at least 15 years after the youngest participant turns 18, at which point it will be securely destroyed.

Professor Tim Silk will be the data custodian for this study. De-identified data collected may be shared with researchers outside of Deakin University and researchers who have not been named on this Plain Language Statement. Any data sharing will be done using secure, password-protected access approved by Deakin University.

The results of this research project will be published and/or presented in a variety of forums, including in scientific journals. De-identified data collected for this study may also be used in future research that is closely related to this study or in the same research area. Results will only be presented in aggregate form, so no individual can be identified. You can request a copy of any published outcomes from the Student Investigator.

If you would like to receive a summary of the study's findings, you can enter your email address into a separate link at the end of the survey (this will not be associated with your survey responses to preserve anonymity).

What should I do if I want to discuss this study further before I decide?
If you would like further information, please contact Emily Friedel (Student Investigator): e.friedel@deakin.edu.au or (03) 9246 8439.

Who should I contact if I have concerns about the conduct of this study?
If you have any complaints about any aspect of the project, the way it is being conducted or any questions about your rights as a research participant, then you may contact:

Human Research Ethics Office, Deakin University, 221 Burwood Highway, Burwood Victoria 3125, Telephone: 9251 7129, research-ethics@deakin.edu.au.
Please quote project approval number 2025/HE001102.

Thank you
Thank you for considering this invitation. You can download a copy of this information sheet to keep on the next screen.

You can access the video study information by clicking this link: Caregiver Plain Language Statement Video

You can access the audio study information by clicking this link: Caregiver Plain Language Statement Audio

*** You can download a copy of the study information to keep by clicking on this link: Caregiver plain language statement ***

Understanding PLS

Have you understood the Plain Language Statement about this research?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No
- ○ I have questions or require assistance

Consent

By answering yes, I agree to the following:

- I am over 18 years old.

- I am providing consent for myself and for my child.
- I confirm I am the parent or legal guardian of the child I am providing consent for.
- I agree to my own participation and my child's participation in this research and give my consent freely.
- I understand this means my child and I will each complete a 10–15 minute survey.
- I confirm that my child has age appropriate capacity to decide whether to participate in this research.
- I understand that the project will be conducted as described in the Plain Language Statement.
- I give consent for my de-identified data and that of my child to be used in future research that is closely related to this study or in the same research area.
- I have had the opportunity to have questions answered to my satisfaction.

○ No

○ Yes

Name and email

Please type your full name here

First Name

Surname

Please type your email address here to receive the survey links for you and your child

Email

Survey links

The information on the next screen will be sent to the email you provided. You should receive an email within an hour. If you can't see one, please check your spam and promotions folders.

Please go through to the next screen to ensure you receive the email.

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